

5.1 Introduction

Online resources can be classified based on different types of information that they contain. The broad types are:

Knowledge Web sites:

These discuss the basic aspects of digital imaging, design, the intersection of geometry and art, software and hardware, etc. Web sites that carry information about the applications that are the tools of the trade are also clubbed in to this chapter.

Tutorial Web sites

These offer tutorials regarding the use of different applications in the digital imaging arena. Web sites offering downloadable content like Plug-ins that enhance the capability of an application can also be clubbed in to this category. Similarly, Web sites conducting online contests test one's mastery of an application, and also come under this genre of resources.

Showcase Web sites:

These sites enable artists to display their art, and appreciate the work of other fellow artists. Some websites also make it easier for visitors to the gallery who like a piece of art to buy it online.

Networking/Collaboration Web sites:

These are places where digital imaging aficionados can meet and exchange ideas. The numerous forums found online are also filed under different sections really help in this. Incidentally, probably because of the graphical nature of the subject, newsgroups are not a preferred place for discussion. Various newsgroups dedicated to different applications are not as active as the forums mentioned here are.

We shall tackle the Web sites of the first category in this chapter. We will see the remaining categories in the two chapters that follow.